

Last Order

Concept Document

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Pitch Line

Two trucks. One final delivery. The whole city watches to see who is faster. The first to line up 4 consecutive packages completes the final delivery and wins. It's a test of strategy, precision, and quick reflexes. Who will be the ultimate last-mile champion?

Introduction

Last Order is a competitive and fast-paced game that reimagines the classic Connect 4, turning it into a delivery race between two rival trucks. Each player represents a delivery company trying to complete the last route of the day before their competitor. The goal is simple: connect four packages on the board to complete a delivery—but pulling it off requires far more than just luck.

The board is patrolled by a logistics drone that moves continuously across the columns. To drop a package, the player must click exactly when the drone is over the desired column. Each turn lasts only 10 seconds, creating a fast and unforgiving pace where strategy, precision, and quick reflexes are essential. A delayed decision may mean missing your turn, and a single mistake can give your opponent the chance to complete the winning line.

Demographic Breakdown

Despite its simple controls, the game requires strategy, quick reflexes, and precision. For this reason, it is recommended for ages 8 and up and is only available on PC.

Feature List

- Competitive 1v1 Matches;
- Connect 4-Style Board;
- Continuously Moving Logistics Drone;
- Time-Limited Turns;

- Frenetic and Strategic Gameplay;
- Corporate Rivalry Theme;
- Win by Alignment.

Feature List Breakdown

- **Competitive 1v1 Matches:** Two players compete to be the first to complete a delivery by connecting four packages.
- **Connect 4-Style Board:** Gameplay takes place on a classic vertical grid where packages fall to the bottom or onto other packages.
- **Continuously Moving Logistics Drone:** A logistics drone flies horizontally across the columns. The player must time their click to the desired column to drop a package.
- **Time-Limited Turns:** Each player has only 10 seconds to make a decision and act, increasing the pressure and pace of the game.
- **Frenetic and Strategic Gameplay:** A fast-paced experience that demands quick reflexes as well as tactical planning to outmaneuver the opponent.
- **Corporate Rivalry Theme:** Each player represents a rival delivery company battling to dominate the "last route of the day."
- **Win by Alignment:** The first player to form a line of four packages—horizontally, vertically, or diagonally—wins the game.

Formal Description

Game State:

The game state contains all relevant information at any given moment of the match:

- **board[COLS][ROWS]:** Matrix representing the game board. Possible values are 0 (empty), 1 (red), or 2 (blue).
- **current_player:** Identifies the current player (CELL_RED or CELL_BLUE).
- **drone_col:** Index of the column currently being flown over by the drone (range 0–6).
- **drone_direction:** Direction of the drone's movement (1 for right, -1 for left).

- **time_left**: Time remaining for the current turn in seconds (integer, initial value is 10).
- **turn_timer**: Active timer responsible for decrementing time_left.
- **game_running**: Boolean flag indicating whether the match is still in progress.
- **winner**: Stores the winner when the game ends (CELL_RED, CELL_BLUE, or a value for a draw).

S={board,current_player,drone_col,drone_direction,time_left,game_running,winner}

Game View:

What each player can see on the interface:

- The game board with the pieces already placed (board).
- The current column position of the drone (drone_col).
- The remaining time for the current turn (time_left).
- An indication of which player's turn it is (current_player).
- After the match ends: a victory or draw message (winner_text).

Game Setup:

Initial game state:

- All board cells are initialized with value 0: board[col][row] = 0
- Current player: CELL_RED (red player starts)
- Drone position: drone_col = 0
- Drone direction: drone_direction = 1 (moving right)
- Time remaining: time_left = 10
- Game status: game_running = true (game active)
- Winner: winner = null (undefined)

S0={board=0,current_player=CELL_RED,drone_col=0,time_left=10,game_running=true}

Player Actions:

During their turn, each player can perform one of the following actions:

- `drop_piece()`: Drops a piece into the column currently being hovered over by the drone.
- `wait()`: Performs no action, letting the time run out. (If `time_left` reaches 0, the turn is automatically passed to the opponent).

Note: The drone's movement is automatic and continuous; players do not control it directly.

$A = \{\text{drop_piece}(), \text{wait}()\}$

Victory Conditions:

- **Victory:**
A player wins by aligning four consecutive pieces, either horizontally, vertically, or diagonally:

$$\text{check_win}(\text{col}, \text{row}) = \text{true} \Rightarrow \text{winner} = \text{current_player}$$

- **Tie:**
The game ends in a tie when all spaces on the board are filled and neither player has met the winning condition:

$$\text{check_fullboard}() = \text{true} \Rightarrow \text{winner} = \text{Tie}$$

$V = (\text{check_win} \vee \text{check_fullboard})$

Progression of Play:

Each turn proceeds as follows:

1. The game begins with the red player.
2. A drone moves continuously along the top of the columns.
3. The player presses the SPACE key (`ui_accept` action) to drop a piece into the selected column.
4. The system then checks if the move results in a win or a draw.
5. If not, the turn passes to the other player.
6. If the turn timer runs out, the player loses their turn automatically.
7. The game ends when a player wins or the entire board is filled (resulting in a draw).